Class 7 Social Science – Chapter 10

CBSE NCERT | Exploring Society: India and Beyond, Part 1

The Constitution of India — An Introduction

Simple English
Exam Preparation
Textbook Solutions

इस अध्याय के सभी textbook exercise questions के उत्तर और प्रत्येक topic से महत्वपूर्ण तथा संभावित प्रश्न-उत्तर नीचे सरल अंग्रेजी में दिए गए हैं। सामग्री आपकी अपलोड की गई पुस्तक के पृष्ठ 209–228 पर आधारित है।

Part 1: Topic-wise Important Questions and Answers

Topic 1: What Is a Constitution?

Q1. What is a Constitution?

Answer: A Constitution is a document that lays down the basic principles and laws of a country. It explains how the government works and protects the rights of citizens.

Q2. Why do we need a Constitution?

Answer: We need a Constitution to establish rules for the country, form the government, protect citizens' rights, settle disputes and ensure fairness and justice.

Q3. Why is the Constitution called the rulebook of a country?

Answer: The Constitution is called the rulebook of a country because it lays down the basic rules and principles according to which the country is governed.

Q4. What are the main things contained in a Constitution?

Answer: A Constitution generally contains:

1. The structure and formation of the government.
2. The functions of different organs of government.
3. The rights and duties of citizens.
4. The political system of the country.
5. The values, ideals and guiding principles of society.

Q5. Why should everyone follow the Constitution?

Answer: Everyone should follow the Constitution because it maintains order, protects rights, promotes equality and ensures that the government works according to established rules.

Q6. What might happen if a country had no Constitution?

Answer: Without a Constitution, there could be confusion about government powers and citizens' rights. Leaders might misuse their powers, and disputes might become difficult to settle fairly.

Q7. What is meant by checks and balances?

Answer: Checks and balances are arrangements that prevent any one organ of government from misusing its powers. They promote fairness, responsibility and accountability.

Topic 2: How Was the Indian Constitution Prepared?

Q8. What was the Constituent Assembly?

Answer: The Constituent Assembly was the body formed to prepare and write the Constitution of India.

Q9. When was the Constituent Assembly formed?

Answer: The Constituent Assembly was formed on 9 December 1946.

Q10. How many members were there in the Constituent Assembly initially?

Answer: It initially had 389 members. After the Partition of India, its membership was reduced to 299. There were 15 women members.

Q11. Who was the Chairman of the Constituent Assembly?

Answer: Dr. Rajendra Prasad was the Chairman of the Constituent Assembly.

Q12. Who chaired the Drafting Committee of the Indian Constitution?

Answer: Dr. B. R. Ambedkar chaired the Drafting Committee.

Q13. When was the Constitution of India adopted?

Answer: The Constitution was adopted on 26 November 1949.

Q14. When did the Constitution of India come into effect?

Answer: The Constitution came into effect on 26 January 1950. This day is celebrated as Republic Day.

Q15. How long did it take to prepare the Indian Constitution?

Answer: The Constituent Assembly worked for almost three years to prepare the Constitution.

Q16. Why was it important to have representatives from different backgrounds in the Constituent Assembly?

Answer: India is a large and diverse country. Representatives from different regions, professions and social groups helped bring different experiences and viewpoints into the Constitution-making process.

Q17. Why do we celebrate Republic Day on 26 January?

Answer: We celebrate Republic Day on 26 January because the Constitution of India came into effect on that day in 1950.

Topic 3: Influences on the Indian Constitution

Q18. What influenced the making of the Indian Constitution?

Answer: Three major influences shaped the Indian Constitution:

1. The Indian freedom movement.
2. India's civilisational heritage and culture.
3. Useful ideas from the constitutions of other countries.

Q19. How did the freedom struggle influence the Constitution?

Answer: The freedom struggle inspired ideals such as equality, justice, freedom and fraternity. These values became important principles of the Indian Constitution.

Q20. How did India's civilisational heritage influence the Constitution?

Answer: India's heritage contributed ideas such as respect for different viewpoints, the importance of knowledge, respect for women, care for nature and the idea that the world is one family. The Constitution also includes Fundamental Duties.

Q21. What is the meaning of “Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam”?

Answer: “Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam” means “The world is one family.” It teaches us to respect and care for all people.

Q22. What does “Sarve Bhavantu Sukhinah” mean?

Answer: It means “May all be happy.” It expresses the wish for the well-being of everyone.

Q23. Which countries influenced the Indian Constitution?

Answer: The Constitution makers studied the constitutions of France, the USA, the UK, Ireland, Australia and other democratic countries.

Q24. Which constitutional ideas were influenced by France, Ireland and the USA?

Answer:

- France: The ideals of liberty, equality and fraternity.
- Ireland: The Directive Principles of State Policy.
- USA: The concept of an independent judiciary.

Q25. Why did the Constitution makers study other countries' constitutions?

Answer: They studied other constitutions to learn useful democratic ideas and adapt them to India's needs and conditions.

Topic 4: The Three Organs of Government

Q26. What are the three organs of government?

Answer: The three organs of government are the legislature, the executive and the judiciary.

Q27. What is the function of the legislature?

Answer: The legislature makes laws for the country.

Q28. What is the function of the executive?

Answer: The executive implements laws and runs the administration of the country.

Q29. What is the function of the judiciary?

Answer: The judiciary interprets laws, settles disputes and ensures that laws are in accordance with the Constitution.

Q30. What is the separation of powers?

Answer: Separation of powers means dividing government responsibilities among the legislature, executive and judiciary so that each organ performs its own functions.

Q31. Why is the separation of powers important?

Answer: It prevents the concentration and misuse of power. It also helps maintain fairness and accountability in government.

Q32. What is the three-tier system of government in India?

Answer: India has three levels of government:

1. Central Government.
2. State Government.
3. Local Government.

Q33. Why does India have different levels of government?

Answer: India is a large country with many people and different local needs. Different levels of government help manage national, state and local matters effectively.

Topic 5: Key Features of the Indian Constitution

Q34. What are the key features of the Indian Constitution?

Answer: The key features include:

1. A democratic system of government.
2. Fundamental Rights.
3. Fundamental Duties.
4. Directive Principles of State Policy.
5. An electoral system.
6. Separation of powers.
7. A three-tier system of government.
8. The guiding values stated in the Preamble.

Q35. What are Fundamental Rights?

Answer: Fundamental Rights are basic rights guaranteed by the Constitution. They protect people's freedom and equality. People can approach courts to protect their Fundamental Rights.

Q36. Name some Fundamental Rights mentioned in the chapter.

Answer: Some examples are:

- Right to Equality.
- Right to Freedom.
- Right against Exploitation.
- Right to Education.

Q37. What is Article 14 of the Indian Constitution?

Answer: Article 14 guarantees equality before the law and equal protection of the laws.

Q38. What is Article 21?

Answer: Article 21 protects life and personal liberty.

Q39. What is Article 21-A?

Answer: Article 21-A provides the Right to Education for children aged 6 to 14 years.

Q40. What are Fundamental Duties?

Answer: Fundamental Duties are the responsibilities that citizens are expected to follow towards the country, society and the environment.

Q41. Name some Fundamental Duties.

Answer: Some Fundamental Duties are:

1. To respect the Constitution, the National Flag and the National Anthem.
2. To defend the country when required.
3. To preserve India's rich cultural heritage.
4. To protect the natural environment.
5. To strive for excellence.
6. To provide educational opportunities to children aged 6 to 14 years, as a parent or guardian.

Q42. What are the Directive Principles of State Policy (DPSP)?

Answer: The Directive Principles of State Policy are guidelines for the government. They aim to promote public welfare, social justice and better living conditions.

Q43. Give examples of Directive Principles of State Policy.

Answer: Examples mentioned in the chapter include:

- Article 38: Social, political and economic justice.
- Article 41: Welfare measures.
- Article 44: Uniform Civil Code.
- Article 47: Nutrition, standard of living and public health.
- Article 48-A: Protection of the environment and wildlife.
- Article 49: Protection of monuments and places of national importance.

Q44. Differentiate between Fundamental Rights and Directive Principles of State Policy.

Fundamental Rights	**Directive Principles of State Policy**

They protect basic rights of people.	They guide the government towards public welfare.
They can be enforced through courts.	They are not directly enforceable through courts.
They protect individual freedoms and equality.	They promote social and economic goals.
Example: Right to Equality.	Example: Improving public health.

Q45. Why are both Fundamental Rights and Directive Principles important?

Answer: Fundamental Rights protect the freedoms and equality of citizens. Directive Principles guide the government in building a fair and welfare-oriented society. Together, they help achieve the goals of the Constitution.

Topic 6: The Constitution as a Living Document

Q46. Why is the Indian Constitution called a living document?

Answer: The Indian Constitution is called a living document because it can be amended to meet the changing needs of the country while preserving its constitutional principles.

Q47. What is a constitutional amendment?

Answer: A constitutional amendment is a formal change made to the Constitution according to the prescribed procedure.

Q48. When were Fundamental Duties added to the Constitution?

Answer: Fundamental Duties were added in 1976.

Q49. When was the Panchayati Raj System incorporated into the Constitution?

Answer: The Panchayati Raj System was incorporated through the 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act in 1992.

Q50. How can the Constitution be amended?

Answer: The Constitution can be amended through the procedure prescribed by the Constitution. Amendments are debated in Parliament, and some also require approval by state legislatures.

Q51. Who wrote the original Constitution by hand?

Answer: Prem Behari Narain Raizada wrote the text of the original Constitution by hand.

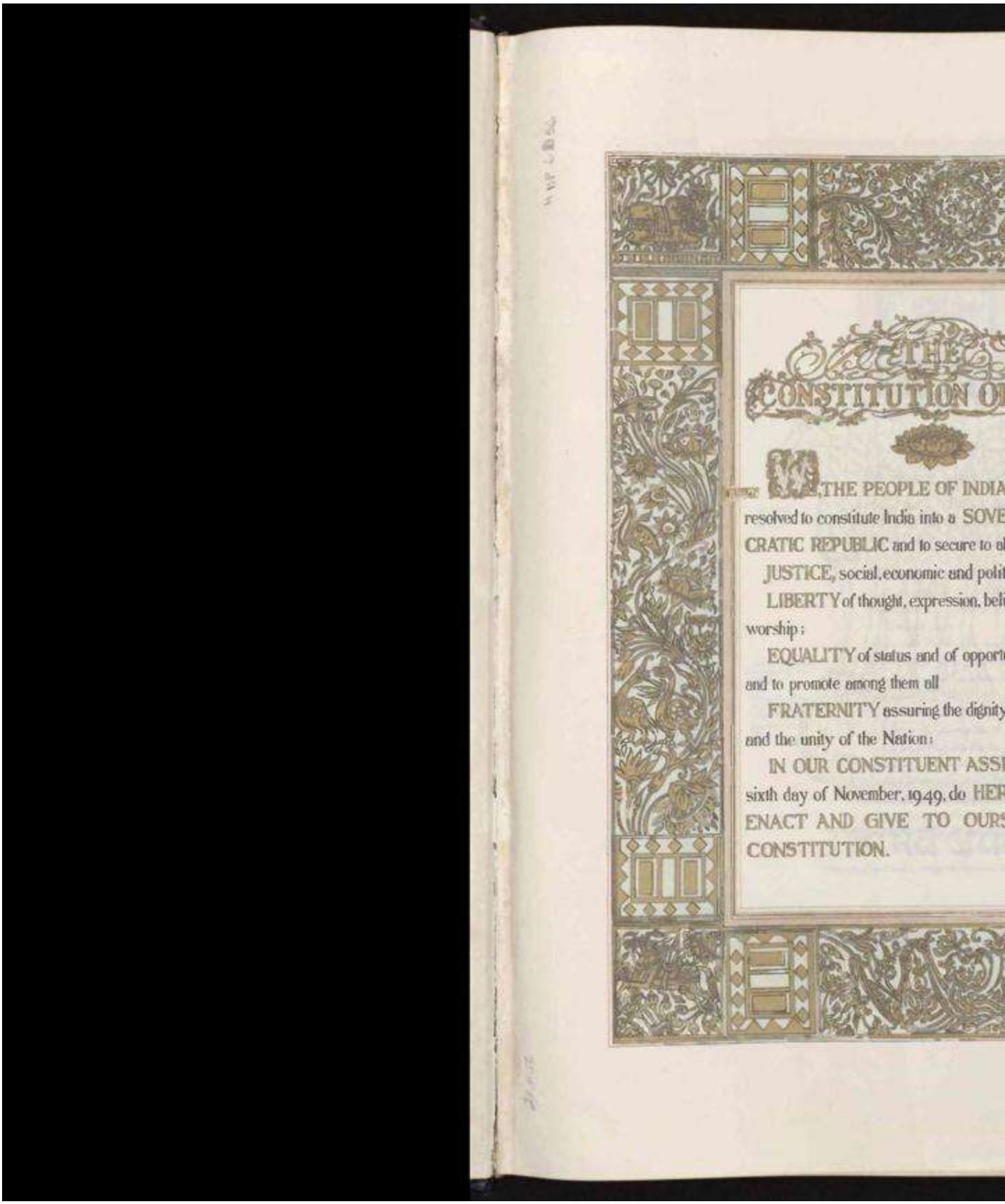
Q52. Who illustrated the pages of the original Constitution?

Answer: Nandalal Bose and his team illustrated its pages with scenes from Indian history and culture.

Q53. How is the original Constitution preserved?

Answer: The original Constitution is carefully preserved in a helium-filled glass case in Parliament. Helium helps protect the document from damage caused by reactions with the gas.

Topic 7: The Preamble of the Indian Constitution



THE
CONSTITUTION O

WE, THE PEOPLE OF INDIA
resolved to constitute India into a SOVE
CRATIC REPUBLIC and to secure to al
JUSTICE, social, economic and polit
LIBERTY of thought, expression, beli
worship;
EQUALITY of status and of opport
and to promote among them all
FRATERNITY assuring the dignity
and the unity of the Nation;
IN OUR CONSTITUENT ASS
sixth day of November, 1949, do HER
ENACT AND GIVE TO OURS
CONSTITUTION.

Q54. What is the Preamble?

Answer: The Preamble is the introductory statement of the Constitution. It explains the main values and ideals on which the Constitution is based.

Q55. What are the main ideals mentioned in the Preamble?

Answer: The main ideals are justice, liberty, equality and fraternity. The Preamble also describes India as sovereign, socialist, secular, democratic and a republic.

Q56. What does “We, the People of India” mean?

Answer: It means that the Constitution derives its authority from the people of India. The people are the ultimate source of political power.

Q57. What does sovereign mean?

Answer: Sovereign means that India is independent and has the power to make its own decisions without control by an external power.

Q58. What does socialist mean?

Answer: Socialist expresses the aim of reducing socio-economic inequalities and promoting the welfare of all people.

Q59. What does secular mean?

Answer: Secular means that India has no official state religion and the government treats all religions with equal respect.

Q60. What does democratic mean?

Answer: Democratic means that people have equal political rights, elect their representatives and can hold their government accountable.

Q61. What does republic mean?

Answer: A republic is a country where the head of state is elected, rather than inheriting the position.

Q62. What does justice mean in the Preamble?

Answer: Justice means ensuring social, economic and political fairness and reducing discrimination and inequality.

Q63. What does liberty mean?

Answer: Liberty means freedom of thought, expression, belief, faith and worship, subject to constitutional limits.

Q64. What does equality mean?

Answer: Equality means that all people are equal before the law and should have equal opportunities without unfair discrimination.

Q65. What does fraternity mean?

Answer: Fraternity means a feeling of brotherhood and unity among all citizens. It encourages people to respect one another and live together peacefully.

Q66. Which words were added to the Preamble by the 42nd Constitutional Amendment in 1976?

Answer: The words “Socialist”, “Secular” and “Integrity” were added by the 42nd Constitutional Amendment in 1976.

Q67. Why is the Preamble important?

Answer: The Preamble explains the guiding values of the Constitution. It helps us understand the kind of society and country India aims to build.

Part 2: All Textbook Exercise Questions and Answers

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Q1. “The Constituent Assembly had representatives from diverse backgrounds in India.” Why do you think it was important to have a diverse set of representatives from all over India?

Answer: India is a large country with many languages, cultures, religions and social groups. Representatives from different backgrounds brought their ideas and experiences to the Constituent Assembly. This helped the Constitution reflect the needs, rights and aspirations of people from different parts of India.

Q2. Read the statements carefully and identify the key features or values of the Constitution reflected in each statement.

(a) Sheena, Rajat and Harsh are standing in a line. They are excited to cast their first vote in the general elections.

Answer: Democracy and universal adult franchise. Eligible adult citizens have the right to vote and choose their representatives.

(b) Radha, Imon and Harpreet study in the same class in the same school.

Answer: Equality and fraternity. Children from different backgrounds can study together as equals.

(c) Parents must make arrangements to ensure their children's education.

Answer: Fundamental Duties. Parents or guardians have a duty to provide opportunities for education to children aged 6 to 14 years.

(d) People of all castes, genders and religions can use the village well.

Answer: Equality and justice. Everyone should have equal access to public facilities without discrimination.

Q3. It is said that "All citizens in India are equal before the law." Do you think this is a fact? If yes, why? If not, why not? Formulate your arguments.

Answer: Yes, equality before the law is a constitutional principle guaranteed by Article 14. Every person is entitled to equal protection of the laws, regardless of caste, religion, gender or social background.

However, discrimination and unequal treatment may still occur in practice. We must ensure that laws are implemented fairly and that everyone can access justice.

Q4. India is the only country that provided universal adult franchise to its citizens from the beginning. Can you explain why India did it?

Answer: India adopted universal adult franchise because the Constitution makers believed in democracy and equality. They wanted every eligible adult citizen to have an equal right to vote, regardless of caste, religion, gender, wealth or social status. This helped establish a democratic system based on equal political rights.

Q5. How did the freedom struggle inspire the making of the Constitution of India? How did India's civilisational heritage inspire some of its key features?

Answer: The freedom struggle inspired the Constitution makers to include equality, justice, liberty and fraternity. The struggle against British rule also strengthened the demand for self-government and democratic rights.

India's civilisational heritage contributed ideas such as respect for different viewpoints, the importance of knowledge, respect for women, care for nature and the belief that the world is one family. These ideas influenced the Constitution, including its Fundamental Duties.

Q6. Do you think we, as a society, have achieved all the ideals of the Constitution? If not, what can we each do as citizens to move our country closer to these ideals?

Answer: No, we have not achieved all the ideals of the Constitution. Problems such as discrimination, poverty, inequality and lack of equal opportunities still exist.

As citizens, we can:

1. Respect the rights of others.
2. Treat everyone equally.
3. Avoid discrimination based on caste, religion or gender.
4. Follow the Constitution and our Fundamental Duties.
5. Protect the environment.
6. Help disadvantaged people and promote education.
7. Participate responsibly in democratic activities.

By following these practices, we can help build a more just, equal and united India.

Q7. Solve the crossword to uncover important concepts from the Indian Constitution.

The clues are given on page 228 of your textbook.

No.	Clue	Answer
Across 2	The branch of government that makes laws	Legislature
Across 7	The part of the Constitution that outlines citizens' duties	Fundamental Duties
Across 8	The highest court in India that protects the Constitution	Supreme Court
Across 9	A system where the head of state is elected, not hereditary	Republic
Across 10	The process by which the Constitution can be changed	Amendment
Down 1	The group of people who wrote the Indian Constitution	Constituent Assembly
Down 3	The statement at the beginning of the Constitution that tells us its values	Preamble
Down 4	The document that lays out a country's rules and laws	Constitution
Down 5	The gas used to preserve the original Constitution safely	Helium
Down 6	Basic rights given to citizens, such as freedom and equality	Fundamental Rights

Part 3: Additional Important Long-Answer Questions

These questions are useful for revision and examination preparation.

Q68. Explain the importance of the Constitution in a democratic country.

Answer: The Constitution is important in a democratic country for the following reasons:

1. It establishes the structure of the government.
2. It defines the powers and responsibilities of government institutions.
3. It protects the Fundamental Rights of citizens.
4. It ensures that the government follows established laws.
5. It promotes justice, equality, liberty and fraternity.
6. It provides a framework for resolving disputes and amending laws.

Thus, the Constitution helps democracy function fairly and effectively.

Q69. Explain the difference between Fundamental Rights, Fundamental Duties and Directive Principles of State Policy.

Answer:

Fundamental Rights	Fundamental Duties	Directive Principles
Protect the basic rights of citizens.	Describe responsibilities expected of citizens.	Guide the government towards public welfare.
Can be enforced through courts.	Are constitutional duties of citizens.	Are not directly enforceable through courts.
Example: Right to Equality.	Example: Protecting the environment.	Example: Improving public health.

All three help promote a responsible government and a better society.

Q70. Why is the Preamble called the guiding spirit of the Constitution?

Answer: The Preamble expresses the main values and goals of the Constitution. It describes India as sovereign, socialist, secular, democratic and a republic. It also promises justice, liberty, equality and fraternity. These ideals guide the government and citizens in building a fair and united country.

Q71. How does the Constitution protect the rights of citizens?

Answer: The Constitution guarantees Fundamental Rights, including equality before the law and protection of life and personal liberty. It prohibits certain forms of discrimination and exploitation. If Fundamental Rights are violated, people can approach the courts for protection.

Q72. Why is equality important in India?

Answer: Equality is important because India has people from different castes, religions, languages and social backgrounds. Equality ensures that everyone receives equal protection

under the law and has fair opportunities. It also helps reduce discrimination and promotes national unity.

Q73. Explain the role of the judiciary in protecting the Constitution.

Answer: The judiciary interprets laws, settles disputes and ensures that laws follow the Constitution. It protects Fundamental Rights and can examine whether government actions or laws violate constitutional provisions.

Q74. How can students practise constitutional values in daily life?

Answer: Students can practise constitutional values by treating classmates equally, respecting different religions and cultures, avoiding discrimination, helping others, protecting the environment and following school rules. They can also learn about their rights and responsibilities as citizens.

Part 4: Quick Revision — Important Dates and Facts

Date or fact	Information
9 December 1946	Constituent Assembly first met
26 November 1949	Constitution adopted
26 January 1950	Constitution came into effect
1976	Fundamental Duties added; Preamble amended through the 42nd Amendment
1992	73rd Constitutional Amendment Act integrated Panchayati Raj into the Constitution
2004	The chapter describes the legal development concerning citizens flying the National Flag at home
Dr. Rajendra Prasad	Chairman of the Constituent Assembly
Dr. B. R. Ambedkar	Chairman of the Drafting Committee
Prem Behari Narain Raizada	Handwrote the original Constitution
Nandalal Bose and his team	Illustrated the Constitution

Part 5: One-Minute Revision

Remember these five key points before your examination:

- Constitution: The basic rulebook of a country.
- Constituent Assembly: Prepared the Indian Constitution.
- Three organs: Legislature makes laws, executive implements laws and judiciary interprets laws.

- Three important constitutional elements: Fundamental Rights, Fundamental Duties and Directive Principles of State Policy.
- Preamble: Explains the guiding values of the Constitution — justice, liberty, equality and fraternity.

Exam tip: First learn the dates, important personalities and definitions. Then practise the textbook questions, especially the questions on the Constituent Assembly, the influences on the Constitution, Fundamental Rights, Directive Principles and the Preamble. These topics form the foundation of this chapter.